

5-Day Gym Program

Build Muscle & Strength • High Volume • Full Gym
Split: Upper • Lower • Push • Pull • Legs — cardio done separately

How to run it

Leave ~1–2 reps in reserve on big compound lifts; take isolation moves close to failure. Rest 2–3 min on compounds, 60–90 sec on isolation. **Progressive overload is the engine:** when you hit the top of a rep range with clean form on every set, add the smallest weight increment next session. Log every set and aim to beat last week. On the long days (1 & 5), superset antagonists (biceps+triceps, rear delts+lateral raises) to save time.

DAY 1 — UPPER

Full upper body

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Log (weight)
Incline Barbell Press	4 × 6–10	
Flat Machine / DB Press	3 × 10–12	
Weighted Pull-up / Lat Pulldown	4 × 8–12	
Close-Grip Lat Pulldown	3 × 10–12	
T-Bar Row	4 × 8–12	
Seated DB Shoulder Press	3 × 8–12	
Lateral Raise	4 × 12–20	
Reverse Pec Deck (rear delt)	3 × 15–20	
EZ-Bar Curl	3 × 8–12	
Hammer Curl	3 × 10–15	
Triceps Pushdown	3 × 10–15	
<i>Core: Hanging Leg Raise</i>	3 × 10–15	

DAY 2 — LOWER

Legs (no direct abs — squat/deadlift brace the core)

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Log (weight)
Barbell Back Squat	4 × 6–10	
Romanian Deadlift	4 × 8–12	
Leg Press	3 × 10–15	
Seated Leg Curl	4 × 10–15	
Walking Lunge	3 × 10–12 / leg	
Standing Calf Raise	4 × 10–15	

DAY 3 — PUSH

Chest / shoulders / triceps

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Log (weight)
Flat Barbell Bench Press	4 × 6–10	
Incline DB Press	3 × 10–12	
Cable Fly / Pec Deck	3 × 12–15	
Machine Shoulder Press	3 × 8–12	
Lateral Raise	4 × 12–20	
Face Pull (rear delt)	3 × 15–20	
Overhead Cable Triceps Ext.	3 × 10–15	
Triceps Dips	3 × 10–15	
<i>Core: Weighted Decline Sit-Up</i>	3 × 12–15	

DAY 4 — PULL

Back / biceps / rear delts (no direct abs — deadlift braces the core)

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Log (weight)
Deadlift (or Rack Pull)	3 × 5–8	
Wide Lat Pulldown	4 × 8–12	
Seated Cable Row	4 × 8–12	
Single-Arm DB Row	3 × 10–12	
Rear Delt Fly	3 × 15–20	
Barbell / EZ Curl	3 × 8–12	
Incline DB Curl	3 × 10–15	

DAY 5 — LEGS (+ upper finisher)

Legs plus rear delts / arms / core

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Log (weight)
Hack Squat / Front Squat	4 × 8–12	
Hip Thrust (or RDL)	4 × 8–12	
Barbell Reverse Lunge	3 × 8–12 / leg	
Leg Extension	4 × 12–20	
Lying Leg Curl	4 × 10–15	
Seated Calf Raise	4 × 15–20	
Rear Delt Fly	3 × 15–20	
Preacher / Cable Curl	3 × 10–15	
Overhead Triceps Ext.	3 × 10–15	
Skullcrusher or 2nd Pushdown	3 × 10–15	
<i>Core: Captain's Chair Leg Raise</i>	3 × 12–15	
<i>Core: Ab Wheel / Pallof Press</i>	3 × 8–12	

Weekly Volume per Muscle

Muscle	Sets/wk	Muscle	Sets/wk
Chest	~17	Quads	~21
Back	~25	Hamstrings	~16
Side delts	~12	Glutes	high
Rear delts	~12	Calves	~8
Biceps	~15	Core / abs	~12
Triceps	~15		

Core / Abs Strategy

- Trained on **Days 1, 3, 5** (non-consecutive). Kept off Days 2 & 4 so the core is fresh for heavy squat and deadlift.
- **Loaded flexion** (builds the six-pack): Hanging Leg Raise, Weighted Decline Sit-Up, Captain's Chair Leg Raise — add weight over time.
- **Anti-movement bracing** (carries over to big lifts): Ab Wheel / Pallof Press.

Recovery & Adjustment

- This is genuinely high volume. If a muscle stops recovering or a joint aches, **remove 2–4 sets** from it — the Day 5 arm/delt/core finishers are the first to trim.
- Volume only builds muscle if you recover from it. Sleep 7–9 h.

Nutrition & Habits

- Protein: ~1.6–2.2 g per kg of bodyweight per day.
- Eat at or slightly above maintenance calories to grow.
- Consistency beats perfection — 5 solid sessions a week for months is what transforms you.

Exercise Alternatives (swap by preference / availability)

Same muscle & movement — any swap keeps the program's intent intact.

Muscle	Alternatives
Chest	Incline Press → DB / Smith / Machine / Low-High Cable Fly · Flat Press → DB / Hammer Strength / Smith / Weighted Dips · Fly → Pec Deck / Cable Fly / DB Fly
Back	T-Bar Row → Chest-Supported / Seal / Machine / Pendlay / Barbell Row · Pulldown → Wide / Close-grip / Pull-up / Single-Arm · Row → Seated Cable / Single-Arm DB / Meadows
Shoulders	Press → Barbell OHP / Arnold / Smith / Landmine · Lateral → Cable / Machine / Lean-Away · Rear Delt → Pec Deck / Cable Fly / Face Pull / Band Pull-Apart
Biceps	Curl → DB / Cable / Machine / Preacher · Hammer → Rope / Cross-Body / Reverse / Zottman · Incline → Bayesian Cable / Spider / Concentration
Triceps	Pushdown → V-Bar / Single-Arm / Machine Dip · Overhead → Rope / DB / Single-Arm Cable · Skullcrusher → EZ / DB / JM Press / Close-Grip Bench
Quads	Reverse Lunge → Walking Lunge / Bulgarian Split Squat / Step-Up · Squat → Front / Safety-Bar / Hack / Smith / Belt · Leg Press → Hack / Pendulum / V-Squat
Hamstrings	RDL → Stiff-Leg / DB / Single-Leg / Good Morning / Cable Pull-Through · Leg Curl → Seated / Lying / Standing / Nordic / Glute-Ham Raise
Glutes	Hip Thrust → Glute Bridge / Machine Hip Thrust / Single-Leg / Cable Kickback / Step-Up
Calves	Standing → Smith / Leg-Press Calf Press / Hack-Squat Calf / Single-Leg DB · Seated → Plate-Loaded Machine / DB-on-Knee
Core	Leg Raise → Captain's Chair / Hanging Knee / Lying / Reverse Crunch / Toes-to-Bar · Decline Sit-Up → Cable Crunch / Ab-Machine / Kneeling Cable · Bracing → Plank / Body Saw / Dead Bug / Suitcase Carry